ECONOMICS 2302.01/02/03: PRINCIPLES OF MICROECONOMICS
Spring 2022 – Face to-face Tues/Thurs. 1:00PM – 2:20PM Bayou 2234 & Online

INSTRUCTOR:
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Office Hours: Tuesdays 2:25 – 3:55PM; Thursdays: 2:25-2:55PM, and by appointment online

EMAIL NOTES:
Please e-mail cotten@uhcl.edu. I don't check Blackboard messages. I should respond within a business day. If I don't, the most likely reason is that I opened your e-mail and started to reply, it got marked read, and then someone busted in to distract me, the phone rang, the light turned green, or the person I'm spotting gets mad I'm not picking the weight up off them. Regardless, I didn't finish my response and forgot. E-mail me again. I know you might be writing on your phone, so I won't hold you to a Victorian formal letter. Just please identify yourself, what class you're in, be specific for questions, and be polite.

REQUIRED TEXTBOOK: Mankiw, N.G. *Principles of Microeconomics* (9th edition) with MindTap. ISBN-13: 9780357530436. You automatically get an e-text when you register for MindTap in Blackboard.

PREREQUISITES:
None, although college algebra will be handy by this point.

COURSE DESCRIPTION AND LEARNING OBJECTIVES:
Economics is a social science –the study of human and social behavior – that has important implications for all business disciplines. Microeconomics is the subset of economics which focuses on behavior by individual entities (people, firms, governments) as they respond to finite resources.

As a social science, ECON2302 is expected to focus on the application of empirical and scientific methods for studying human behavior, explore the interactions and behavior among individuals, groups, institutions, and their impact on the individual, society, and culture, and to address critical thinking, communication, quantitative skills, and social responsibility.

Students will achieve these goals by applying graphical and mathematical models of individual, firm, and government behavior, developing the vocabulary used by economists, exploring optimal and suboptimal decision making among agents, and exploring the impact of economic decisions on third parties (social impacts).

Material covered include opportunity costs, gains from trade, supply and demand, social welfare, tax incidence, externalities, the structure of the firm, and various market structures.

All face-to-face students may use the online materials and take online exams and online students may attend face-to-face and take face to face exams as they wish. Everything is interchangeable.

COURSE STRUCTURE

Grades: Your course grade composition will be the **greater** of:

1) Your exam average.
2) 2/3 your exam average and 1/3 your average on MindTap assignments.

Note: I will not calculate your average or final exam target grade mid-semester. Formula is right here.

Your letter grade will be the **greater** of:

1) 90s A, 80s B, 70s C, 60s D, sub-60 F. – grades end in 0,1,2; + grades end in 7,8,9 (no A+)
2) Top 15% A, next 25% B, next 25% C, next 15% D, bottom 20% F. +/- grades at my discretion

Assignments:

Exams: There are three multiple-choice exams with 30-40 questions each. They may be taken face to face or online with ProctorU (more on that below).

1. They are closed-book, closed-notes, no formula sheet. If taking it in person, the exam will be your scratch paper. If you take it online, ***you may use a whiteboard or blackboard that can be erased as a form of scratch paper.*** You may have any calculator that cannot access the internet or send text messages.
2. You may take a comprehensive final *in place of* exam 3 to replace *all* exam grades, even if the new grade is lower. Therefore, if you miss one of the first two exams for any reason, you will take the comprehensive exam.
3. Missing the third exam without a zero will require documentation of a serious circumstance that rendered you unable to take the exam at either the face to face or remote times. You will then take the comprehensive exam to replace all exam grades.
4. ProctorU requires startup time. If you schedule your exam too close to closing and ProctorU cannot get you checked in before their reservation window closes, you have missed the exam. I recommend leaving at least an hour.

ProctorU is a live online proctoring service that allows you to take your exam from the comfort of your home. ProctorU is available 24/7, however, you will need to schedule your proctoring session at least 72 hours in advance to avoid any on-demand scheduling fees. Creating a ProctorU account is simple. You can do so by clicking here or going to www.proctoru.com.

In order to use ProctorU, you will need a high-speed internet connection, a webcam (internal or external), a Windows or Apple Operating System, and a government issued photo ID. ProctorU recommends that you visit https://test-it-out.proctoru.com/ prior to your proctoring session to test your equipment. We recommend you click on the button that says “connect to a live person” to fully test out your equipment. Please make sure that you are using the current version of your browser and have

Additionally, please visit and review the test-taker resource center here. You should expect the startup process with the proctor to take about 10-15 minutes. However, this time will not affect your exam time. Please feel free to direct any questions to the student support team via the live chat within your account

If you wait until 72 hours before the exam to make an appointment with exam proctoring with ProctorU there is an extra $5 charge. To take the exam immediately (during the testing window) the fee is an additional $8.75.

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MindTap: So here's the deal with MindTap. MindTap is Cengage's digital learning platform. MindTap isn't perfect and is still kludgy in places, and you'll find some videos that feel a little too cute – like government antismoking commercials – but it integrates video lessons directly into the textbook, allows you to create practice exams – which students in prior semesters report is immensely helpful - applies concepts to real-world news items, allows to create and manipulate graphs without too much effort, and take notes directly on the textbook. There are a ton of exercises to bring you up to speed on things like manipulating fractions and reading graphs you may have fallen behind on. A lot of them are assigned as part of your grade, because again the research says that you learn better if you do a lot of small tasks that keep you at pace through the course, but there are a ton more that you can do for practice. While the number of assignments is quite large, the size of each one is pretty small. You'll roll your eyes, but I'd honestly do all of them for each chapter.

The MindTap assignments can be loosely divided into four categories:

1) Chapter quizzes. These are basic multiple choice questions about the chapter you've just read that are *normally* due before the face-to-face class where we start covering that topic. This is an incentive to have read the chapter before we discuss it, which will make class much more useful.
2) Video lessons, Concept Clips: These are brief videos/exercises that walk you through some of the concepts in the class and manipulate graphs to explain economic relationships. I generally only assign these for areas that are very important for future work in the class or where students historically struggle. They're typically less than 3 minutes of your time and generally worth about 3 points each and **you generally only have one attempt**.
3) News Analyses: These apply the concepts to items that have been in the news recently. They're a little more involved and are typically worth about 4-8 points. You get **three** attempts and receive the **average** of all three attempts.
4) Homework: These may be done three times and your grade is the ***average*** of all three attempts, so don't phone it in on the first effort. These are often worth between 15-30 points and are the most important of the MindTap assignments.

Assignment Type	Point calculation	Points each	Due Date
Chapter Quizzes	Best of two attempts	10	Immediately before class
Video Lessons	One attempt	3	Saturday after topic
Concept Clips	One attempt	3	Saturday after topic
News Analyses	Average of three attempts	3-7	Saturday after topic
Homework	Average of three attempts	14-28	Saturday after topic

The deadlines are there to keep you on track. **If you miss the due date, you may submit the assignment late for a flat 25% score deduction**. This deduction is in place for 1 minute late or through the final exam, and is designed to be large enough to incentivize you to stay on schedule but small enough that they're still worth doing if you miss the deadline. Assignments not turned in by the final exam receive a grade of zero.

Your MindTap contribution to your grade will be the ratio of points earned to total points, multiplied by 35. Sometimes MindTap can be annoying. I've had it display graphs with quantities in '000s where the answer might be 500. On some questions, it wants 500 in the box. In others, it wants 500,000.. Let me know on the discussion board so I can fix it, but it's not going to be decisive in your grade. Because life happens**, I will credit all students 6 percentage points on their MindTap average at the end of the course**. This will more than cover any glitches mentioned above.

One more warning about MindTap. The sync between MindTap and Blackboard is generally close, but sometimes a little off. Whatever your grade is reported as in MindTap itself is what will be used to calculate your grade at the end of the course.

Extra Credit: The College of Business has several researchers who need student volunteers for their studies. You may register for these studies by going to https://uhcl-bus.sona-systems.com and registering to receive notifications. If you participate, you may allocate the credit to any class that is participating in the system. I will be informed *at the end of the semester* as to what studies you have completed and the credit earned. You may allocate a maximum of 2 credits to this class, which will give you +2 points on your final course grade.

Furthermore, there may be a handful of in-class extra credit opportunities where we play incentivized games to illustrate various concepts. Some will be done using MobLab software, where you will need a computer or other portable device. Unfortunately, it seems as if iPhones struggle, so anything else will work.

CLASS POLICIES

Please do the following:

1. Ask polite questions about the material on the discussion board. I love questions, because it shows that you are engaged with the material and it gives me feedback on what is confusing *before* the exam. I will be e-mailed, and other students can chime in and answer and/or benefit from the question. Anything of a personal nature you can e-mail me directly.
2. If you make an appointment to see me, please show up.
3. If my office door is open and I'm not around, please look around the general vicinity. I'm nearby.

As I said before, I add six percentage points to your MindTap grade at the end of the semester, which is the equivalent of two points on your final average. This covers the deduction from turning in roughly eight assignments late. In exchange for this coverage against life getting in the way of your work, you are expected to avoid doing any of the following:

1. Request or demand to be accommodated/extended on MindTap assignments for any reason.
2. Request or demand extra credit, both in the form of more work or just a bump in grade.
3. Request or demand to reschedule an exam. The dates are in the syllabus right now and the provisions for missing an exam are already provided.

If you do any of the above, you will lose your six extra MindTap points and will likely be told no anyway.

An incomplete may be awarded to a student who can prove in a single submission of verifiable documentation that they suffered an unexpected catastrophic event after the withdrawal date and had a passing grade in the course at the time. The comprehensive make-up final will be used to replace all grades and will be taken as soon as possible.

A note about GroupMe, or similar setups where you can share information online. We're into the 2020s. Technological tools like this are fine and use them as best you can. This is the most popular banking textbook and I'm using the textbook questions so that it will tie into the study plan software, but this means you can look up a lot of the homework and quiz questions online anyway. Help each other with the homeworks and quizzes, and there's no issue. Use them to learn though, or the exams will get you.

However, if you share information about an exam with other students, you have committed an academic honesty violation. The first person to report someone to me who is subsequently convicted of doing so receives 10 points *on their course grade.* This incentive is designed to *prevent* cheating, but one time a student did and my inbox exploded with screenshots from their classmates, so it also works as enforcement.